Parallel 79°

Product Positioning Playbook

WORKSHOP

Your Unique Positioning + AI = Improved Sales Productivity

OVERVIEW

What We're Building Today

Agenda

01 Understanding AI Fundamentals

02 Setting Up Your Environment

03 The Positioning Framework

04 Building Your Playbook

05 Using Your Playbook

06 What's Next

What You Leave With

✓ A complete Positioning Playbook

✓ Competitive battlecards ready for sales

✓ A personalised call prep tool

✓ A working mental model of AI systems

CHAPTER 01

Understanding The Fundamentals

The mental model behind everything we build today.

LLMs vs. Chatbots

Chatbot

An interface over a simple system.

Retrieves or matches patterns.
Responds to the immediate prompt.

Most corporate chatbots are scripted.

CLAUDE IS THIS

Reasoning Engine

Understands context, follows logic.

Can hold a role, a memory, and a process.

Produces structured, novel outputs from ambiguous inputs.

The Difference

Using Claude as a chatbot is like hiring a brilliant consultant and only ever asking them to write emails.

Today we give it a full brief.

RAG vs. Large Context Windows

RAG

Retrieval-Augmented Generation

Stores docs in a vector database.

Retrieves relevant chunks at query time.

Right for: large, dynamic enterprise datasets.

Large Context Window

Claude: up to 200,000 tokens — 1–2 full novels

Load all files directly into context.

No database. No retrieval pipeline.

Right for: small, bounded datasets like this workshop.

Context windows simplified architecture for small, bounded use cases — but RAG remains essential at scale (cost, dynamic data, "lost in the middle" problem). We use the right tool for each job.

Markdown: The Native Language of AI

01

Density

Packs structure and hierarchy into minimal tokens. More signal, less noise for the model.

02

No Overhead

Plain text. No fonts, footers, or layout artifacts. What you write is exactly what the model reads.

03

File System Native

Lives in folders. Works with version control. Can be written and updated by the AI itself.

Practical rule: Write all company context in structured Markdown — not slide decks or Word docs.

The Problem with Long Chat Threads

01

Lost in the Middle

Models reliably attend to content at the start and end of long contexts — but statistically underutilise content buried in the middle.

Critical instructions pushed to the middle get less influence.

02

Instruction Drift

Later messages dilute the weight of earlier instructions. The model optimises for recent context.

A system prompt at the start weakens as the thread grows.

The solution: replace chat history with a structured, persistent file system.

Memory Architecture: Files Over Chat

Store everything the AI needs in structured files.

The model reads them at the start of every session. Full context. Instantly.

Outputs persist across sessions. Multiple team members share the same vault. The system compounds.

```
your-company/
├ inputs/
│  ├ company.md
│  └ icp.md
├ memory/
│  ├ research/
│  └ playbook/
└ outputs/
   ├ battlecards/
   └ call-plans/
```

Skills, Agents & MCP

SKILLS

Skills

Packaged instruction sets. Claude follows a defined process and produces structured output.

Think SOPs for your AI collaborator.

Repeatable, shareable, improvable.

AGENTS

Agents

AI sessions that operate autonomously across multiple steps — reading files, running searches, writing outputs.

You start it. You come back to results.

MCP

MCP

Anthropic's open protocol for connecting Claude to external tools: CRMs, calendars, Slack, databases.

The plumbing that connects AI to your real systems.

The Tools We're Using Today

BROWSER

Claude.ai

Quick tasks. No persistent file access. No plugin support.

Not what we use today.

DESKTOP APP — TODAY

Claude Desktop

Plugin support. File system access via connected folder. MCP integration.

This is our workshop environment.

TERMINAL

Claude Code

Full file system + shell access. For technical builders.

How the PositioningHQ plugin was originally built.

Cowork is Anthropic's interface for non-developer users inside Claude Desktop. Parallel79° builds the skills and plugins that run inside it.

CHAPTER 02

Setting Up Your Environment

15 minutes. Everyone running before we build.

Getting Started in 5 Steps

01

Install Claude Desktop

Download from claude.ai/download. Sign in with your Claude account.

02

Confirm your subscription

You'll need a paid Claude plan that includes plugin support — check claude.ai for current tiers.

03

Install the PositioningHQ Plugin

Use the install command from the facilitator. Type / and confirm all skills appear.

04

Connect a working folder

Create your company vault folder and connect it as your Claude Desktop workspace.

05

Prepare a rough company brief

What you do, who you serve, 2–3 competitors. No polish needed — the AI structures everything.

CHAPTER 03

The Positioning Framework

What you're building, and why it matters.

> Positioning defines how your product is a leader at **delivering something** that a **well-defined** set of customers **cares a lot about.**

— April Dunford

It's not about what you built. It's about who they are and why they care.

The Guide Mindset

They are the **heroes.** We are the **guide.**

They are **Batman**. We are **Alfred**.

Our job is not to make them care about our product. It's to show ***we understand their mission, and that we have what they need to complete it***.

How We Guide: Empathy + Expertise

We don't talk at them about us. We show empathy and demonstrate expertise.

Show Empathy

We know who you are

ICP

We know what you're trying to do

Customer Jobs

We know the outcome you want

Positive Outcomes

We know how painful it is to fail

Negative Consequences

Demonstrate Expertise

We've done this many times before

Proof

We know what it takes

Value Statements

This is how we do it

Our Solution

This is how we do it better

Distinct Differentiation

The Product Positioning Playbook Framework

Seven elements.

Your solution sits at the center.

Everything surrounding it is customer context you must understand to position your solution.

The Seven Elements

CUSTOMER CONTEXT

01 **Market Overview , The 'Why Now?'** — market shifts and windows of opportunity.

02 **Target Customers & ICP** — Demographic and characteristics of your right-fit customers.

03 **Value Drivers** — The three outcomes your ideal customers find genuinely valuable.

04 **Distinct Advantages (Moat)** — How you do it differently and better than anyone else for your target customers.

05 **Competitive Intelligence** — Deep and up-to-date knowledge of your competitors.

YOUR SOLUTION + PROOF

06 Positioning Your Solution

"Positioning defines how your product is a leader at delivering something that a well-defined set of customers cares a lot about." – April Dunford

07 Proof Points

Proof for what you claim. Customer case studies and testimonials, analyst reports, news, etc. Anything that give credibility to your claims.

CHAPTER 04

Building Your Positioning Playbook

Hands-on. Your company, your vault, your playbook.

The Skill Workflow

`/setup-positioning-vault`

One-time setup
Guided intake + creates vault

→

`/company-research`

9-step market &
competitive analysis

→

`/positioning-playbook`

7-section positioning
playbook

Auto-runs /company-research + /positioning-playbook on first setup

Then use downstream:

`/battlecard`	Competitive battlecards
`/call-plan`	Pre-call briefs
`/product-launch`	Launch planning

What the Playbook Produces

01 Market Overview
"Why Now?" — market shifts and windows of opportunity

02 Target Customers (ICP)
Profile, Jobs to Be Done, buying triggers

03 Value Drivers
3 outcomes with: challenge, status quo, cost of inaction, proof

04 Distinct Advantages
Your moat — what you have that competitors don't

05 Positioning Statement
Internal source of truth + 3 message variations

06 Competitive Intelligence
Per-competitor breakdown — how to win each matchup

07 Customer Proof Points
Real evidence: case studies, metrics, win stories

- *Here is a sample playbook produced by Claude.*

CHAPTER 05

Using Your Positioning Playbook

Battlecards. Call plans. The feedback loop.

Battlecards & Call Plans

/battlecard

One card per competitor. Everything a rep needs to win that deal.

- → Who they are & how they position
- → Where they're strong (be honest)
- → Where they're weak — framed for the conversation
- → How to win: positioning angles + proof points
- → Landmine discovery questions
- → Objection handling

/call-plan

Stage-specific brief: discovery, demo, follow-up, or closing.

- → Opening hypothesis — specific to this prospect
- → Discovery questions tied to your Value Drivers
- → Landmine questions (natural, not attacks)
- → Proof points matched to their industry
- → Objections + responses from your positioning
- → Concrete next step — not 'I'll follow up'

The Feedback Loop

The playbook improves through use. After every significant sales conversation:

Did the discovery questions land?	→ **Refine the Value Drivers.**
Did a prospect use language we haven't captured?	→ **Add it to the ICP section.**
Did we win or lose on a specific competitive point?	→ **Update the battlecard.**
Did a proof point land particularly well?	→ **Elevate it in that Value Driver.**

Share your call notes with Claude — it refines the relevant section for you.

CHAPTER 06

What's Next

Now that you have a playbook — how do you roll it out?

The Rollout Exercise

Map the top opportunity in each category. 15 minutes.

MESSAGING & CONTENT

Messaging

Where is messaging inconsistent?

Which content most needs rebuilding?

Who owns it — do they have the playbook?

SALES & ENABLEMENT

Sales

Which reps will adopt battlecards first?

How does this change new hire onboarding?

What's the highest-friction part of your pipeline?

PRODUCT & ROADMAP

Product

Does your product deliver what positioning promises?

Are there customer jobs you're not addressing?

What changes about your roadmap priorities?

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DEFINE YOUR NORTH

After this workshop:

- our playbook is built.
- Your vault persists.
- **Start using it in the next conversation you have.**

Contact shahed@parallel79.com to facilitate this workshop for you.

ABOUT

Parallel79°

Shahed Khalili

Founder · Parallel79°

Experienced product and growth executive with deep expertise in and hands-on AI skills most executives delegate.

Now helping CEOs and Revenue Leaders learn and deploy AI I their teams **effectively** and **responsibly**.

Three ways to engage:

AI Sales Enablement

Systematize AI across your revenue team. Faster pipeline, better positioning.

AI Chief of Staff

Executive-level AI fluency — for you and your leadership team.

AI Governance & ISO 42001

The sandbox, the policies, the badge. Get ahead of the next SOC 2.

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